

ACTIVITY 4 — LEARNER WORKSHEET**Role Play: Handling Objections & Rejections**

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Role Play	1 hour	LU4	LU4 — Handling Objections & Rejections

Name	
Date	

What you are doing

Sophie sells a high-end home security system. Tom is a homeowner in Bukit Timah whose neighbour was burgled six weeks ago. He requested the quotation himself, sat through the full home assessment, and agreed the system is exactly what he wants.

What you will produce: A completed Role-Play Observer Scorecard classifying each of Tom's responses (objection / deflection / rejection) with the specific technique Sophie used against each, plus the Feel-Felt-Found sequence quoted in full.

The scenario

Then the price came up. Tom's first response is that it costs more than he wanted to spend — but he does not say that his real constraint is a renovation bill arriving next month, and he is slightly embarrassed about it. Later in the conversation he attempts an outright rejection to end the discomfort.

The scene requires Sophie to tell an objection from a deflection from a genuine rejection, validate before solving, use Answer & Ask and a well-matched testimonial, stay composed when Tom becomes short with her, and handle the rejection attempt in a way that keeps the relationship — and the door — open.

Role assignment

Role	Played by	Goal
Sophie — Sales Rep, Home Security		Diagnose each response correctly and respond with empathy before evidence
Tom — Homeowner, Bukit Timah		Protect his budget and his pride without admitting the real reason
Observer / Coach		Score the diagnosis, the validation and the composure

Your steps

1. **Assign the three roles** — One learner plays Sophie (sales rep, high-end home security system), one plays Tom (homeowner, price-sensitive). The rest are Observer/Coach.
2. **Round 1 — classify before responding** — Tom raises the cost concern ('this is a bit expensive for me right now, I was hoping for something more affordable'). Before responding, Sophie (out loud, for the group) names what this is — a genuine objection, not a deflection or rejection — then asks what budget he had in mind.
3. **Round 2 — Answer & Ask, then right-size the offer** — Sophie answers the value question directly, then asks a follow-up to re-engage ('what's most important to you in a security system?'). Once Tom reveals he just wants reliable break-in alerting, not every extra feature, Sophie offers a scaled-down, lower-priced option that matches — rather than defending the original price.
4. **Round 3 — Feel-Felt-Found with a specific testimonial** — Sophie runs the full sequence out loud: Feel ('I understand your hesitation'), Felt ('many clients have felt the same way about the upfront cost'), Found (a specific, concrete story — a client whose alert genuinely caught a break-in). The testimonial must be specific, not a vague 'they loved it.'
5. **Round 4 — handle the later rejection gracefully** — In a follow-up scene, Tom tries to reject outright ('I don't think this is the right time for us'). Sophie tells this apart from the earlier objection, doesn't argue or pressure, and instead leaves the door open with a specific future check-in ('can I check back in a few months?').
6. **Observer completes the scorecard** — For each of Tom's lines, the Observer writes objection / deflection / rejection, plus the exact technique Sophie used in response — and quotes the full Feel-Felt-Found sequence.

Your working space

Complete every field. You may keep this worksheet as your reference after the course.

Step 1 — Assign the three roles

Step 2 — Round 1 — classify before responding

Step 3 — Round 2 — Answer & Ask, then right-size the offer

Step 4 — Round 3 — Feel-Felt-Found with a specific testimonial

Step 5 — Round 4 — handle the later rejection gracefully

Step 6 — Observer completes the scorecard

Answers to the discussion prompts

1. Label each of Tom's three responses: objection, deflection or rejection. Did Sophie's reply match the diagnosis each time?

2. Where exactly did Sophie validate before solving — and was there a moment she jumped straight to the answer?

3. Which question finally surfaced the renovation bill? What made it safe enough for Tom to admit it?

4. When Tom became short and folded his arms, what did Sophie do with her own reaction? What would the five-step routine have changed?

5. Was the testimonial well matched to Tom, and was it deployed at the right moment?

6. Tom attempted an outright rejection. Did Sophie keep the door open in a way that was genuine rather than pushy?

Reflect & discuss

What is the cost of misdiagnosing a deflection as a rejection — and vice versa?

How did naming Tom's feeling out loud change the temperature of the conversation?

Which objection in your own work have you been arguing with instead of validating?

Check your work

The observer can label all three of Tom's responses correctly, quote the line where Sophie validated before answering, name the question that surfaced the real constraint, and describe how the rejection attempt was handled without either caving or pushing.